

Excel Magic

AutoFill · Custom Lists · Merging · Table Magic

AutoFill

Custom List

Merging

Table Magic

SUBJECT: Computer Applications

PREPARED BY: Student Report | Class 10



What We'll Cover

01

AutoFill

Smart data entry that saves time

02

Custom Lists

Build your own fill sequences

03

Merging Cells

Combine cells for better design

04

Table Magic

Supercharge data with Excel Tables

What is AutoFill?

AutoFill automatically fills cells with a series or pattern based on existing data. It saves time by removing repetitive typing.

How to Use It

Enter data in a cell, select it, then drag the small green square (fill handle) at the bottom-right corner down or across.

Types of AutoFill

Numbers (1,2,3...), Dates (Mon,Tue,Wed...), Months (Jan,Feb...), Custom text patterns, and Formulas are all supported.

Flash Fill (Bonus!)

Press Ctrl+E to let Excel detect patterns automatically — great for splitting names, formatting phone numbers, and more.

EXAMPLE:

A (Seed)	B (AutoFill Result)	Type
1	2, 3, 4, 5 ...	Number Series
Monday	Tuesday, Wednesday...	Day Names
Jan	Feb, Mar, Apr ...	Month Names
Q1	Q2, Q3, Q4	Custom Pattern

What is a Custom List?

A Custom List is a user-defined sequence that Excel remembers. Once created, AutoFill can use it just like built-in lists.

How to Create One

Go to File → Options → Advanced → Edit Custom Lists. Type your list items one per line, then click Add and OK.

When is it Useful?

Useful for department names, branch cities, student names, product codes, or any repeating sequence specific to your work.

Using It

Type the first item of your custom list in a cell, then drag the fill handle — Excel auto-completes the rest of your list.

EXAMPLE:

Custom List Example	Fills As...
Mumbai	Pune → Nashik → Nagpur → Aurangabad
Sales	Marketing → HR → Finance → IT
Term 1	Term 2 → Term 3 → Term 4

What is Merging?

Merging combines two or more adjacent cells into one larger cell, making it ideal for titles, headers, and labels.

How to Merge

Select the cells you want to merge. Go to Home tab → Alignment group → click the 'Merge & Center' button (or its dropdown for more options).

Merge Options

Merge & Center: merges and centers content. Merge Across: merges each row separately. Merge Cells: merges without centering. Unmerge Cells: splits back.

Important Caution

Merged cells can cause issues with sorting and formulas. Only use merging for presentation/header rows, not for data rows.

EXAMPLE:

Before Merge	A2	B2	C2
After Merge →	A2 + B2 + C2 merged into one w		
Use Case	Report Title spanning the full row		

What is an Excel Table?

An Excel Table (Ctrl+T) converts a plain data range into a structured, intelligent object with built-in tools and formatting.

Key Features

Auto-filters on every column header, banded rows for readability, automatic expansion when you add new rows or columns, and structured references in formulas.

How to Create

Click anywhere in your data, press Ctrl+T (or Insert → Table), confirm the range and tick 'My table has headers', then click OK.

Table Styles & Totals

Use the Table Design tab to pick colour themes. Enable the 'Total Row' to get instant SUM, AVERAGE, COUNT, MAX and MIN dropdowns at the bottom.

EXAMPLE:

Feature	Plain Range	Excel Table
Auto Filter	Manual setup	Auto included ✓
New Row Expand	Manual	Automatic ✓
Formula Ref	=B2:B10	=Table1[Sales] ✓
Total Row	Not available	One click ✓

Summary & Key Takeaways



AutoFill

Drag the fill handle to auto-complete patterns, dates, and series instantly.



Custom Lists

Create your own sequences so AutoFill knows your custom order.



Merging

Merge & Center joins cells for headers; use with care to avoid formula issues.



Table Magic

Convert data to a Table (Ctrl+T) for auto-filters, styles, and structured refs.

Practice these features daily — they save hours of work!